

8. Candidate supply under a fixed search budget

OUTPUT *Abstract.* In 50 paired opening subtrees with a fixed 50,000-popped-state budget, incremental POS-shape pruning returns 2,137 accepted pairs versus 407 for terminal-only checking: 5.47 times as many accepted pairs per popped state, with a paired-bootstrap interval of 2.89–17.65. It produces 0.95 times as many accepted pairs per generated state. The differing denominators show that pruning changes where the search budget is spent rather than universally improving every efficiency measure.

CRITIQUE A headline 5.47x could be read as a universal algorithmic speedup. The opening subtrees, vocabulary, budget, traversal order, and accepted-pair definition all bound it. The generated-state result also complicates a simple pruning-wins story.

REVISION APPLIED Present this as a fixed-work candidate-supply case study, include both denominators and the interval, and avoid claims about prose quality or general search superiority.